

2.5 Colour Balancing—Hue/Saturation Adjustments

With just this one tool, you can make a seemingly dull and boring picture look colourful and vivid. A lot can be said about saturation adjustments, but we will only introduce you to the basics, and leave you to explore the endless possibilities.

This setting is found in Image > Adjustments > Hue/Saturation, or by pressing [Ctrl] + [U]. There you will see three settings—Hue, Saturation and Lightness. Let's start with a simple definition of each of these terms.



In computer graphics, the Hue, Saturation, Brightness (or lightness), known as HSB, is a model that can describe all possible colours. Here, the hue refers to the colour itself, saturation is the strength of the hue (can be perceived as its purity), and brightness is the amount of black/white in the colour. Brightness or lightness can also be thought of as the amount of light falling on a particular colour.

In the Hue/Saturation setting box, you will see two lines of colours at the bottom. Initially both the lines are identical, but as you move the Hue slider, the second line changes to show the colours in the first line being replaced by another colour that it (the second line) shows. The colour changes occur according to the mapping that is shown between these two colour lines. The settings can be applied to all colours or to particular colours that are available in the drop down list. Apart from these, you can select the particular ranges of colours using the slider that you see in between the two lines we mentioned earlier.